

LifeHelpers

Touching
Lives,
Transforming
Households,
Impacting
communities.

Putting a smile on a Face!

Project Magazine Vol.2



EMPOWERING COMMUNITIES THROUGH INNOVATION, SKILLS & LIVELIHOOD SUPPORT

A Special Feature on the FCDO-funded
Resilience Building and Smallholder Farmers
Support Project, implemented by Life Helpers
Initiative and WFP



World Food
Programme

SAVING
LIVES
CHANGING
LIVES



NOTE

Welcome to the first edition of Gidan Arziki Impact Magazine. This publication captures the inspiring story of transformation, empowerment, and community resilience unfolding through the Gidan Arziki Centers across Katsina State. From commissioning to full operation, the centers have become symbols of opportunity, innovation, and sustainable livelihood development for women, youths, and smallholder farming communities.

Through the collaborative efforts of the Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office (FCDO), the World Food Programme (WFP), and Life Helpers Initiative (LHI), the Farmers Hubs have evolved into vibrant community enterprise centers designed to strengthen local economies and improve self-reliance. Beyond infrastructure, these hubs represent hope, practical empowerment, and pathways toward economic stability for vulnerable households.

Inside these pages, you will discover the stories behind the progress, the voices of trainees and community members, the commitment of development partners, and the remarkable achievements recorded across the facility units. From vocational training and agro-processing to cold room operations, charging services, and enterprise development, this edition highlights the growing impact of the Gidan Arziki Centers in building resilient communities and expanding livelihood opportunities.

As we reflect on the progress recorded during this reporting period, we celebrate not only operational milestones and financial growth, but also the resilience, determination, and collective effort driving sustainable community transformation across Katsina State.

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LEADERSHIP

LENS



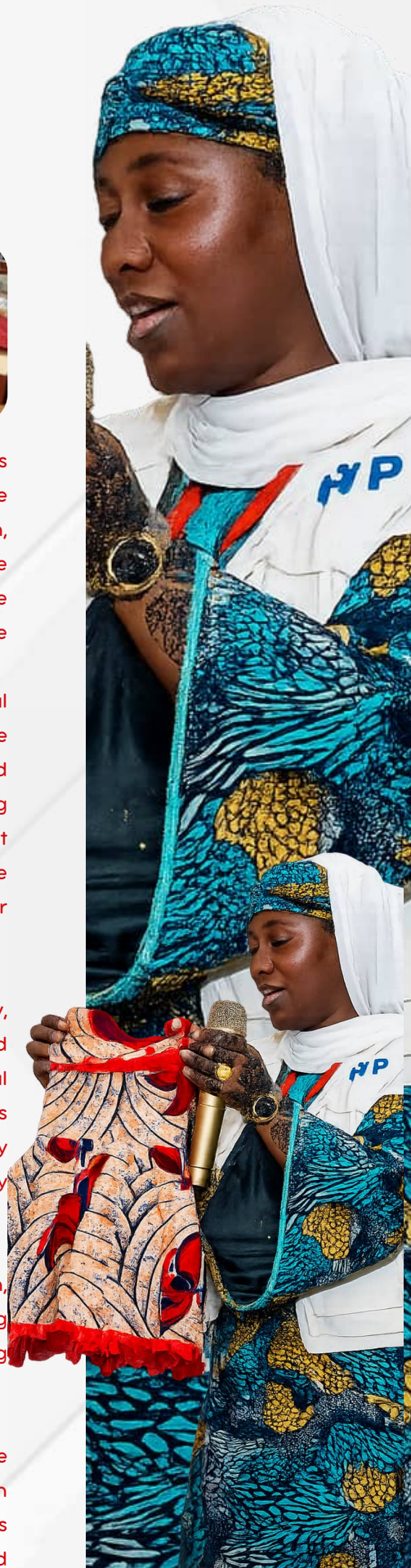
Across communities in Katsina State, the Gidan Arziki Farmers Service Hub is creating new pathways for economic empowerment, self-reliance, and sustainable livelihoods. Through the collaborative support of World Food Programme, Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, and Life Helpers Initiative, vulnerable households, women, and youths are gaining access to practical skills, enterprise opportunities, and essential community services designed to strengthen resilience and improve living conditions.

From the commissioning of the centers to the operationalization of vocational training units, agro-processing facilities, cold room services, and enterprise support activities, the initiative was established with a clear vision: to build community-driven hubs capable of transforming local economies and creating long-term opportunities for growth. Today, the centers are becoming vibrant spaces where innovation meets opportunity, and where community members are empowered with the tools, knowledge, and support needed to improve their futures.

The journey goes beyond infrastructure and statistics; it is about restoring dignity, building confidence, and creating sustainable opportunities for individuals and families. Youths are acquiring vocational and tailoring skills that promote financial independence, smallholder farmers are accessing improved processing services that reduce post-harvest losses and increase productivity, and community members are benefiting from affordable services that support their daily livelihoods.

Beyond strengthening livelihoods, the initiative is fostering hope, social inclusion, and community ownership. By investing in local capacities and creating opportunities closer to home, the Gidan Arziki Farmers Service Hub is helping communities build a more secure and sustainable future for generations to come.

We remain deeply grateful to our donors, partners, community leaders, the Katsina State Government, and beneficiaries whose resilience and dedication continue to inspire meaningful change. As the impact of the Gidan Arziki Farmers Service Hub continues to grow, so does the hope for stronger, more resilient, and economically empowered communities across Katsina State.



The Big

PICTURE:

OVERVIEW

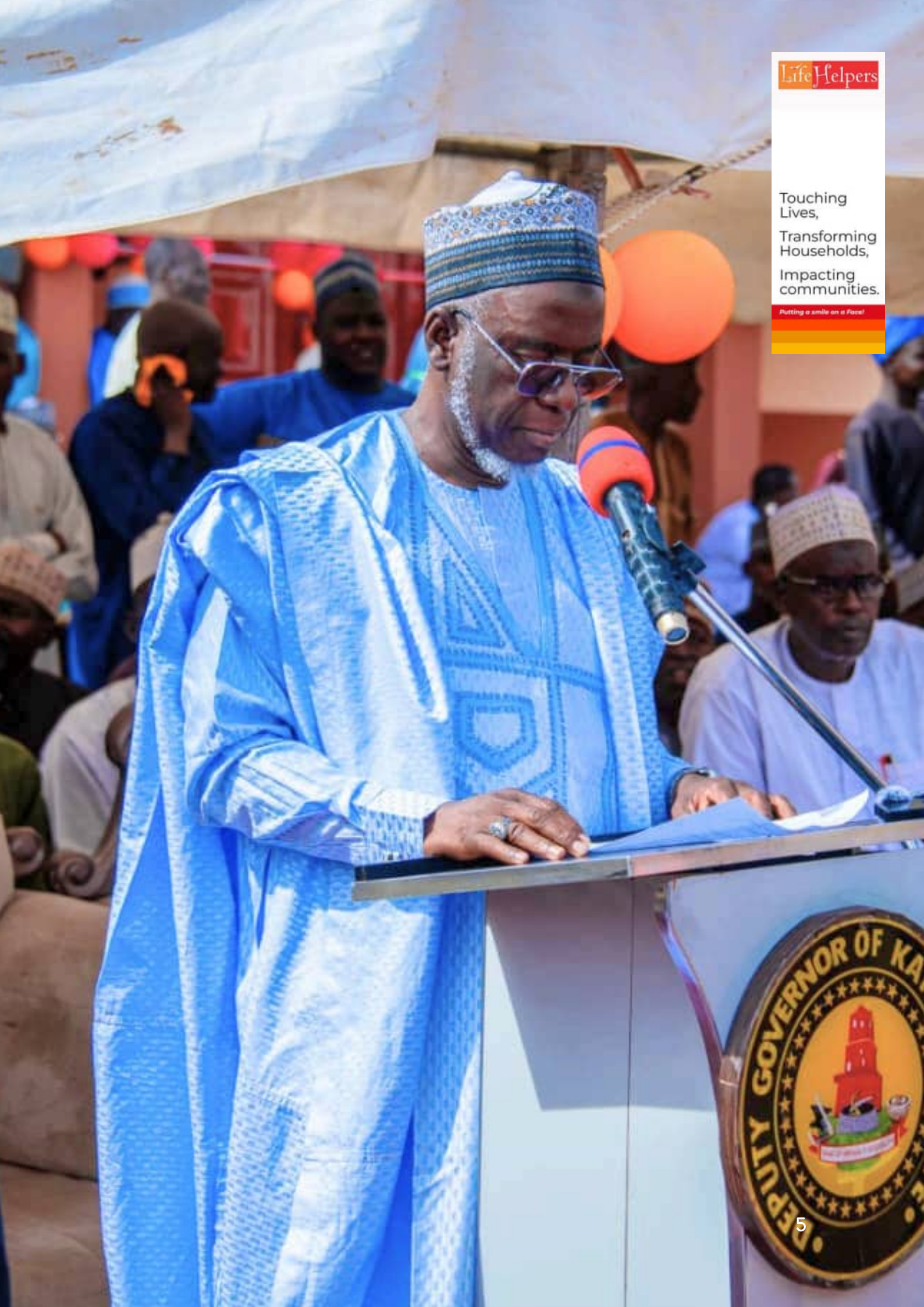
The month of April 2026 marked a historic milestone for the Gidan Arziki Center in Batagarawa Local Government Area of Katsina State with the successful commissioning of the facility. The commissioning ceremony, held on April 27, 2026, attracted dignitaries from the state government, development partners, community leaders, and stakeholders committed to sustainable livelihood development and economic empowerment.

Representing the Executive Governor of Katsina State, the Deputy Governor, Faruk Lawal Jobe, officially commissioned the center and described the project as a transformative initiative with the potential to strengthen livelihoods, improve community resilience, and empower women and youths across the state. He applauded the collaborative efforts of WFP, FCDO, and LHI in establishing a facility capable of creating lasting social and economic impact.

The event featured facility inspections, interactions with beneficiaries, and a ceremonial tree planting exercise carried out by government officials and stakeholders. During the inspection tour, the Deputy Governor expressed satisfaction with the vocational training unit, agro-processing activities, and the overall quality of the center. He particularly commended the initiative for equipping young women with practical and income-generating skills that encourage self-reliance and economic independence.

The commissioning further strengthened community trust and government ownership while demonstrating the positive impact of donor investment in local economic development. Stakeholders present at the event also advocated for the replication of similar centers in other Local Government Areas across Katsina State.





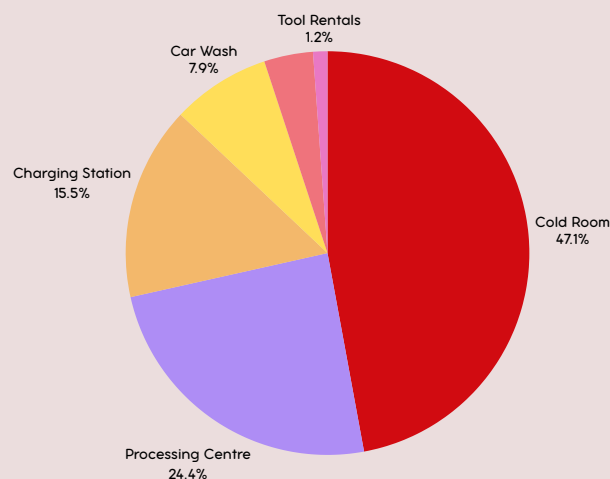
The Impact

TIMELINE

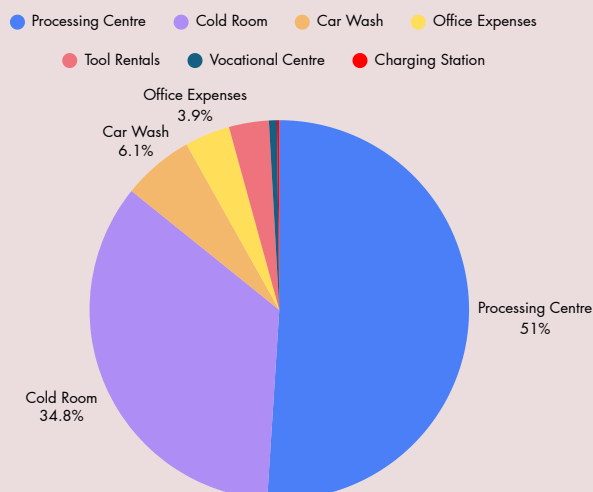
Project at a Glance:
Major Activities and
Milestones Across
Sokoto and Katsina

PIE CHART DATA – REVENUE BY UNIT AS AT APRIL 2026

Unit	Amount (₦)
Cold Room	457,985
Processing Centre	237,210
Charging Station	151,000
Car Wash	76,860
Business incubation	38,100
Tool Rentals	11,200



PIE CHART DATA – EXPENDITURE BREAKDOWN



Expense Category	Amount (₦)
Processing Centre	300,150
Cold Room	204,600
Car Wash	35,750
Office Expenses	22,720
Tool Rentals	20,000
Vocational Centre	4,000
Charging Station	1,150

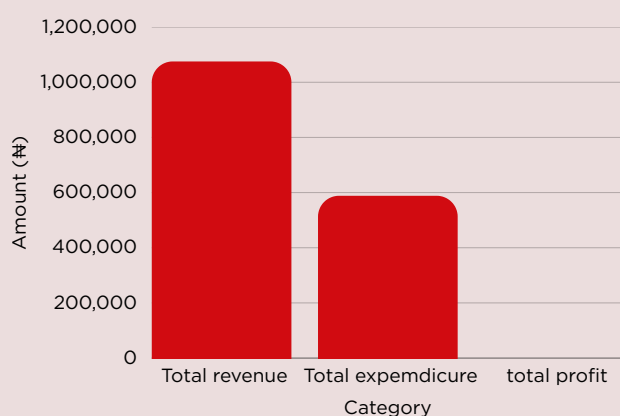


CHART DATA – PROFIT ANALYSIS

Category	Amount (₦)
Total Income	1,075,365
Total expenditure	588,370
Total Profit	486,995



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FACILITY OPERATIONS

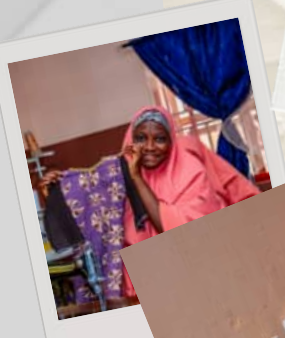
SUCCESS

Strengthening Livelihoods Through Community Enterprise

The Gidan Arziki Center remained fully operational and continued to provide a wide range of income generating and community support services. The facility maintained active operations across its processing, vocational, cold room, charging, and agro-processing units, contributing significantly to economic participation and community engagement within Batagarawa LGA.

The Agro-Processing Unit has two sections: the general grinding section and the groundnut oil extraction section. The grinding section remains one of the most active units in the facility, providing grinding services primarily to community members and smallholder farmers. To improve efficiency and productivity, routine maintenance and repairs were carried out on operational machines. In addition, a new groundnut grinding machine was acquired to increase output capacity and enhance service delivery.

The Groundnut Oil Extraction Unit continued the production of groundnut oil and kuli-kuli (peanut cake) in April 2026. The unit not only sustained production but also benefited women in the community who had previously relied on manual processing methods. Beyond production, women received training on the use of modern processing methods, good hygiene practices, and product branding and packaging to improve market appeal and consumer acceptance.



FACILITY OPERATION

SUCCESS

Strengthening Livelihoods Through Community Enterprise

The Charging Station maintained steady operations, with additional charging equipment procured to improve efficiency and expand customer service delivery. This unit continues to attract and excite community youth due to its affordable charging fees, the safety of customers' gadgets, and the quality customer service provided at the centre.

The Cold Room Unit also expanded its operations during the reporting period through the introduction of Fura da Nono, a locally consumed dairy product aimed at meeting dietary preferences and increasing customer patronage. Existing services such as water chilling and The Cold Room Unit also expanded its operations during the reporting period through the introduction of Fura da Nono, a locally consumed dairy product aimed at meeting dietary preferences and increasing customer patronage. Existing services such as water chilling and ice block production continued successfully and contributed significantly to the facility's overall revenue generation.

One of the major achievements recorded so far, is the commencement of business incubation, which layered in 3 aspects. Firstly, the learning on how to sew, which presently has a total of 30 trainees. The second is the use of the sewing machines by those who already sews but have no sewing equipment. Each of the aspects attracts a fee for the hub. The last is the sewing and sales of hijabs, veil materials and bedsheets. All these are well structured, managed and supervised. This initiative is equipping women and youth with practical vocational skills that can improve household income and promote economic independence.

The Car Wash Unit and Tool Rental Unit also became fully operational, further expanding access to affordable services while creating additional income generating opportunities for the youths benefiting the wider community.





Voice of Change

REAL LIVES

REAL IMPACT

STRENGTHENING FARMING COMMUNITIES IN KATSINA STATE



For Engineer Salim Suleiman, Managing Director of the Katsina State Irrigation Development Authority (KSIDA), the partnership between Life Helpers Initiative and government institutions is yielding visible results across Katsina State.

Since the start of the intervention, farmers have received improved seeds, fertilizers, water pumping machines, and access to farm support centers that provide continuous technical assistance. These inputs have strengthened productivity and improved the efficiency of rural farming systems.

"Life Helpers Initiative has helped us a lot in supporting farmers, especially in the local government areas," Engr. Suleiman notes. "They have done very well in complementing government efforts because government alone cannot reach every community."

He explains that the collaboration is closing critical service gaps while improving livelihoods for rural households who depend on agriculture for survival and income. According to him, such partnerships demonstrate the value of coordinated development approaches in strengthening food systems.

"We all know that farmers in rural areas are the backbone of the economy," he adds. "Life Helpers and WFP have done a lot, and we hope to see more of their work going forward."

Through improved access to resources and knowledge, the initiative is enhancing resilience, boosting agricultural output, and contributing to broader food security and economic growth across Katsina State.



At 70 years old, Arajana Suleiman, a mother of eight from Batagarawa community, never expected to regain a strong sense of purpose. Through a community supported agricultural center implemented by the World Food Programme (WFP) and Life Helpers Initiative, she has found renewed meaning in daily life.

"Coming here every morning gives me hope and makes me feel healthy," she says. Insecurity had previously limited her access to her farmland, but the center provided a safe environment where she can work, earn income, learn new skills, and connect with others.

Before joining the initiative, Arijana struggled with stress and high blood pressure. She now reports improved wellbeing, supported by a consistent routine and social engagement. "Being around people every morning and having something to look forward to makes me happy," she explains.

The introduction of labor saving equipment has also transformed production processes, reducing time and effort while improving efficiency. "Before, the process was very tedious. Now with the machine, we finish in minutes," she says.



Voice of Change

REAL LIVES REAL IMPACT

COMMUNITY TRANSFORMATION IN BATAGARAWA THROUGH INCLUSIVE INNOVATION



In Batagarawa community, residents are witnessing visible transformation through the Gidan Arziki, an innovation supported by the WFP and LHI.

For Alhaji Hassan Isa Batagarawa, the district head (Magaji of Batagarawa,)the intervention represents a major milestone in local development. "As district head, I am very happy about this innovation and the new project that has come to our local government," he says. "It has brought joy and ease to our people."

The multi-purpose community center now serves as a hub of activity, offering affordable services and reliable 24 hour electricity. Women benefit from easier access to milling and processing services, reducing waiting time and physical strain. "Our women can go there without stress, process what they need, and return home quickly," he explains.

The project has also introduced key infrastructure, including a modern slaughterhouse that improves hygiene and environmental standards. In addition, cash assistance has enabled residents to start small businesses, strengthen household income, and build savings.

Youth engagement has increased through opportunities such as car wash services and other income generating activities, reducing idleness and promoting stability.

According to Alhaji Hassan, the initiative is reducing poverty, strengthening livelihoods, and creating lasting opportunities for women and young people across Batagarawa.



MODERN SLAUGHTERHOUSE ENHANCES HYGIENE AND COMMUNITY WELLBEING

As part of Life Helpers Initiative (LHI)'s continued commitment to strengthening community infrastructure and public health, a modern slaughterhouse was reconstructed beside the **Gidan Arziki Farmers Service Hub** to serve Batagarawa and surrounding communities.

The facility was designed to provide a safe, hygienic, and well regulated environment for meat processing during celebrations, cultural events, and everyday community use. By replacing informal slaughtering practices with a structured system, the intervention helps reduce health risks while promoting cleaner and more organized surroundings.

Built to high standards, the slaughterhouse features proper drainage, washable surfaces, and clearly designated processing areas that support improved sanitation and food safety practices. These elements ensure that meat handling aligns with basic public health expectations, safeguarding both consumers and operators.

Community members have already embraced the facility, actively using it during social gatherings and festive periods. For many residents, it represents a long-awaited improvement that brings dignity to food preparation while significantly reducing environmental waste and contamination within the community.

Local leaders describe it as a timely and practical addition to the Gidan Arziki Farmers Service Hub, complementing its broader role in supporting agricultural livelihoods and community services. Beyond convenience, it reflects a growing shift toward healthier, safer, and more sustainable community practices.

Through this development, LHI continues to reinforce its commitment to building resilient communities where infrastructure directly supports health, dignity, and improved quality of life.

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A close-up photograph of Hon. Yahaya Lawal Kawo, Chairman of Batagarawa Local Government Area. He is an older man with a weathered face, wearing a traditional yellow and brown patterned cap and a light blue patterned robe. He is holding a silver microphone to his mouth and appears to be speaking. In the background, several people are visible, including a man in a blue uniform and a woman in a blue headscarf. The scene is outdoors under a clear sky.

Hon. Yahaya Lawal Kawo, Chairman of Batagarawa Local Government Area, also expressed appreciation for the project and reaffirmed the LGA's commitment to sustained collaboration and impact.

Hon. Yahaya Lawal Kawo, Chairman of Batagarawa Local Government Area, also expressed appreciation for the project and reaffirmed the LGA's commitment to sustained collaboration and impact. He noted that he has been very supportive of the initiative in his community and welcomed its implementation. According to him, agriculture remains a key priority area that the Katsina State Government has been actively working to strengthen through empowerment initiatives.

He further expressed hope that similar interventions would be expanded to other parts of the state. He observed that transforming a piece of land into a productive and well-developed site within a short period reflects significant progress and tangible growth in the community.

The Chairman expressed gratitude to the FCDOgovUK, Life Helpers Initiative (LHI), and the World Food Programme (WFP) for their innovation and support, noting that the project has brought visible development and renewed hope to the area.







The Chairman, Batagarawa LGA
Hon. Bala Garba Tsanni

Gidan Arziki

PROJECT OVERVIEW

The Batagarawa Farmer Service Center stands as the second major agricultural hub being established under the FCDO-funded project in Northwest Nigeria. Located in Batagarawa Local Government Area of Katsina State, this facility is designed to replicate the success of the Wamakko model while addressing the unique agricultural needs of Katsina's smallholder farmers.

GOVERNANCE AND SUSTAINABILITY

Learning from the Wamakko model, the project prioritized sustainability from the start. A Facility Management Committee (FMC) was formally established even before construction finished. This committee comprises 20 members (12 male, 8 female), ensuring inclusive governance and women's representation. To prepare for launch, selected farming equipment was transferred to the center and formally handed over to the FMC lead, strengthening accountability and asset management.



April 2026 Report Excerpt: In Batagarawa Local Government Area of Katsina State, the construction of the Farmer Service Center reached 100% completion within just four weeks. By April, the facility was fully operational and officially commissioned, with workers already actively engaged in service delivery and supporting community activities.

Core Agricultural Services

- ⚙️ Agro-Processing Unit
- 🍚 Extension and Advisory Services
- 🏠 Meeting Room
- 🚜 Farm Equipment & Mechanization
- 🛠️ Tool Rental
- ❄️ Cold Room
- 🚗 Car Wash
- 🔌 Charging Dock



Photo Speaks

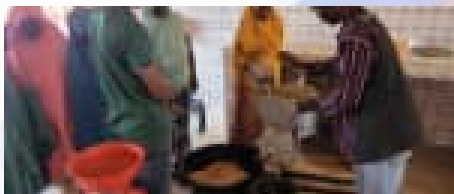
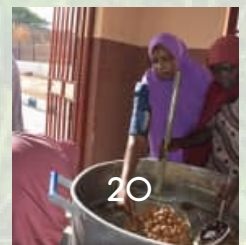


Photo Speaks



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WESPEAK (MUYI MAGANA)

WeSpeak, also known as Muyi Magana, is a weekly radio program implemented by Life Helpers Initiative in Sokoto State and aired weekly by Radio Nigeria (Royal F.M 101.5). The program cuts across all thematic areas, health, education, livelihood, agriculture, and gender equity.

The platform provides timely information, encourages dialogue, and creates space for questions, feedback, and external complaints. Community members share concerns, receive referrals, and learn about available services. Civil society organizations are also invited to use the platform to raise awareness about their work and promote collaboration.

The radio program has touched the lives of many people across Sokoto State by increasing awareness, promoting positive behavior change, and strengthening accountability.

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Be a leading non-governmental organisation working to maximise all opportunities to empower the marginalized people.

OUR VISION

A more Fulfilled Life for Everyone

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